

use them all in order to win. “Strike at the enemy as hard as you can” and “Wear them out,” he said.

Leaving Sherman in charge in the west, Grant personally led the relentless Union attacks by the Army of the Potomac in Virginia, the war’s principal battlefield. He gradually wore down General Robert E. Lee’s forces during the Overland Campaign. The siege of Petersburg and the fall of Richmond followed, which resulted in Lee’s surrender at Appomattox Court House on April 9, 1865. Grant’s generous terms allowed Confederate officers and soldiers to return to their homes.

“The war is over—the **rebels** are **our countrymen again.**”

GRANT AFTER LEE’S SURRENDER AT APPOMATTOX COURT HOUSE, APRIL 9, 1865

Warrior to statesman

After the formal Confederate surrender, Grant disagreed with President Andrew Johnson on his lenient stance toward the South. Grant thought the South should be treated like a conquered nation—a position that won him favor among the more radical Northern citizenship.

Grant won a bid for the presidency in 1868 (and would be re-elected in 1872). However, he did not always conduct himself in the statesmanlike manner that the people expected. He took personal gifts (unaware that it was thought improper), appointed friends to Cabinet positions (which he saw as a form of loyalty), and made sincere—but ultimately disastrous—policy decisions that led the country into a depression. In the “Whiskey Ring,” one of a series of scandals that blighted his administration, corrupt officials stole more than \$3 million in taxes from the Federal government. It is thought that Grant was not personally involved in any of this, but his reputation was tarnished.